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December 22, 2025

Via Overnight UPS Delivery
Mr. Brandon M. Frey
Executive Secretary
Louisiana Public Service Commission
Galvez Building, 12th Floor
602 North Fifth Street
Baton Rouge, Louisiana 70802

RECEIVED
DEC 23 2025
LPSC
Records Division

Re: Application of Entergy Louisiana, LLC for Certification of the Babel-Webre 500kV Transmission Project in Accordance with Louisiana Public Service Commission General Order Dated September 10, 2024
(LPSC Docket No. U-_____)

Dear Mr. Frey:

I have enclosed the original and three copies of a Public Redacted Version of the Application of Entergy Louisiana, LLC ("ELL" or "Company") for Certification of the Babel-Webre 500kV Transmission Project. This filing includes the Direct Testimony of Michelle Bourg, Chad Ladner, Erik Guillot, and Ryan Jones and accompanying exhibits. Please retain the original and two copies for your files and return a date-stamped copy to me in the enclosed self-addressed envelope.

I have also enclosed five copies of the Highly Sensitive Protected Material ("HSPM") Version of the referenced filing, which is being provided to you under seal pursuant to the provisions of the LPSC General Order dated August 31, 1992, and Rules 12.1 and 26 of the Commission's Rules of Practices and Procedures. The confidential materials included in the filing consist of competitively sensitive information and customer-specific confidential information, among other things. The disclosure of the information contained herein would subject not only the Company but also its customers to a substantial risk of harm. Accordingly, it is critical that this information remain confidential.

Please retain the appropriately marked HSPM Version for your files and return a date-stamped copy to me in the enclosed self-addressed envelope. The three additional HSPM copies are for the Administrative Law Judge, Staff Attorney, and Research Attorney. Additional copies of the HSPM Version of this filing will be provided to the appropriate representatives of the Louisiana Public Service Commission Staff and made available to intervenors once a suitable Confidentiality Agreement has been executed by the parties.

If you have any questions, please do not hesitate to call me. Thank you for your courtesy and assistance with this matter.

Respectfully submitted,

Meta C. Danzey

Meta C. Danzey

MCD/jlc
Enclosures
cc: LPSC Commissioners (*public version only via electronic mail*)

BEFORE THE

LOUISIANA PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

APPLICATION OF ENTERGY LOUISIANA, LLC FOR CERTIFICATION OF THE BABEL – WEBRE 500kV TRANSMISSION PROJECT IN ACCORDANCE WITH LOUISIANA PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION GENERAL ORDER DATED SEPTEMBER 10, 2024	)))))))	**DOCKET NO. U-_____**

APPLICATION

OF

ENTERGY LOUISIANA, LLC

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DECEMBER 2025

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APPLICATION OF ENTERGY LOUISIANA, LLC
FOR CERTIFICATION OF THE
BABEL – WEBRE 500kV TRANSMISSION PROJECT
IN ACCORDANCE WITH LOUISIANA PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
GENERAL ORDER DATED SEPTEMBER 10, 2024

Entergy Louisiana, LLC ("ELL" or the "Company") respectfully submits this Application, consistent with the Commission's 2024 Siting Order,[1] seeking certification by the Louisiana Public Service Commission (the "Commission" or "LPSC") that the public convenience and necessity would be served by the completion and siting of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project, including: (1) construction of a new approximately 147-mile 500kV transmission line in Louisiana; (2) reconstruction of the Webre 500kV Switching Station in Louisiana; and (3) coordination with Entergy Texas, Inc. ("ETI") of the construction of an approximately 4-mile 500kV transmission line in Texas and the construction of the Babel Switching Station in Texas (together, the "Babel – Webre 500kV Project" or the "Project").[2]

The Company's Application, including its supporting Direct Testimonies and exhibits, provides the information required pursuant to Section V of the 2024 Siting Order for timely certification that the public convenience and necessity will be served by the completion and siting of the Project. In addition to the requested certification, the Company respectfully requests a

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[1] *See* General Order (September 10, 2024), In re: Review and Possible Modification of the Commission's General Order dated October 10, 2013 Governing Transmission Certification and General Siting ("2024 Siting Order"), Docket No. R-36199.

[2] For the sake of completeness and context, the Babel – Webre 500kV Project also includes components for which the Company is not seeking certification under the 2024 Siting Order. The Company includes in its Application and Direct Testimony descriptions of the reconstruction of the Webre 500kV Switching Station as part of the Project, even though the 2024 Siting Order expressly excludes switching stations from the definition of "Transmission Facility" to which the Commission's certification requirement applies. *See* 2024 Siting Order at Section II(a) (definition of "Transmission Facility").

The Company also includes description of the coordination with ETI of the construction of a 3.8-mile 500kV transmission line in Texas and the construction of the Babel Switching Station in Texas. The certification requested in this Application is for the portion of the transmission line and related components located in Louisiana, which will be owned by ELL. ETI, which will own the portion of the Project located in Texas, will pursue any necessary certification and approval of the portion of the line and the Babel Switching Station in Texas from the Public Utility Commission of Texas ("PUCT"), and ETI will be responsible for paying for the portions of the Project in Texas.

finding that the actual retail revenue requirement associated with the prudently incurred costs of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project is deemed eligible for recovery by the Company through the appropriate recovery mechanism at the time that the components of the Project are placed in service. The Company further requests the development of a schedule and procedures to permit this Application to be considered on a timely basis. The Company shows as follows:

I. INTRODUCTION AND PURPOSE OF PROJECT AND APPLICATION

ELL is a limited liability company duly authorized and qualified to do business in the State of Louisiana, created and organized for the purposes, among others, of manufacturing, generating, transmitting, distributing, and selling electricity for power, lighting, heating, and other such uses.

The Company's filing concerns the Babel – Webre 500kV Project, which is further described below and in the Direct Testimony of other Company witnesses. The Babel – Webre 500kV Project is a Midcontinent Independent System Operator, Inc. ("MISO") MTEP25 Baseline Reliability Project to address projected widespread transmission reliability constraints associated with expected load growth in southeast Louisiana and to enhance reliability and resilience across the area west of Baton Rouge to the Louisiana/Texas state line. The Project scope includes a 151-mile 500kV transmission line from the new Babel 500kV Switching Station in Texas, which will be constructed by ETI, to the reconstructed Webre 500kV Switching Station in Rosedale, Louisiana. Specifically, the Project will extend approximately 147 miles across seven parishes in Louisiana and extend approximately 4 miles across one county in Texas.

As described by Company witness Michelle P. Bourg in her Direct Testimony, economic growth is occurring at an unprecedented rate in southeast Louisiana. The Babel – Webre 500kV Project will address projected widespread transmission reliability constraints associated with

expected load growth in southeast Louisiana, specifically the Amite South area. MISO classified the Project as a Baseline Reliability Project ("BRP") to ensure compliance with mandatory North American Electric Reliability Corporation ("NERC") standards addressing transmission planning reliability and for continued reliable service to ELL customers, informed by significant load growth from customer projects in Ascension Parish and in Iberville Parish. The Babel – Webre 500kV Project is also necessary to maintain compliance with NERC planning regulations with ELL's service to a major new data center load under development in Richland Parish, in northeast Louisiana. With the Commission's approval, the Babel – Webre 500kV Project will play a critical role in ELL's ability to support these customer projects, which will in turn create jobs, tax revenue, and long-term economic development opportunity for Louisiana residents.

ELL respectfully suggests that it is important for the Commission and the State as a whole to send an appropriate policy signal that Louisiana is "open for business" by ensuring that the appropriate infrastructure is in place to accommodate reasonably anticipated load growth. Consequently, time is of the essence because transmission projects of the scope and scale of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project require significant lead time to develop, including time to complete right-of-way ("ROW") acquisition (including judicial expropriation proceedings, where required), obtain required materials, and complete construction. Swift action as to the Babel – Webre 500kV Project is needed for ELL to operate at the speed of business and provide reliable and resilient power, and doing so will benefit communities across southeast Louisiana and the State as a whole.

In addition to supporting expected load growth and the economic development benefits that the growth will provide to Louisiana, the Babel – Webre 500kV Project will provide other significant benefits that are equally important to ELL customers and the Commission, including:

- **improved reliability** by providing a new east-to-west extra high voltage 500kV transmission line that would facilitate regional power flows across the Gulf Coast region and mitigate the risk of transmission emergency-driven load-shed events like the recent May 25, 2025 event;

- **improved resilience** (referring to the ability to withstand and recover quickly from extreme weather events, such as hurricanes) by adding a transmission line that is designed to Entergy's latest wind-load standards and located farther north and farther inland than existing transmission lines that currently move power across the region, thus providing geographic diversity and mitigating the risk of hurricanes that traverse the region from the Gulf Coast;

- **additional load-serving capability** in Louisiana, which will help with accommodating service to and meeting the in-service schedules of industrial block load customers seeking to build new or expanded plants in southeast Louisiana, including the Hyundai Steel Mill project in Ascension Parish, as well as allowing ELL to maintain compliance with NERC regulations as it serves the Laidley, LLC data center project in Richland Parish;

- **resolution of persistent network constraints** identified in the MISO interconnection queue process, which is essential for ELL's long-term generation supply strategy as it faces substantial load growth and significant existing generation in south Louisiana that is nearing the end of its economically useful life;

- **relief of ongoing transmission congestion** along the Gulf Coast; and

- **production cost savings** for Louisiana customers.

Company witness Chad J. Ladner explains in detail how the Babel – Webre 500kV Project will improve reliability; improve resilience; increase load-serving capabilities and manage load pocket growth; mitigate transmission corridor overloads in south Louisiana associated with planned generation additions and future generation retirements; relieve transmission congestion along the Gulf Coast; and create production cost savings for Louisiana customers. Mr. Ladner further explains how this Project will improve the reliability and resilience of the ELL grid,

connecting the Babel 500kV Switching Station, which will be constructed under ETI's SETEX Project, and the Webre 500kV Switching Station. He also explains how the hardened new east-west 500kV transmission path across south Louisiana will fortify the Gulf Coast EHV transmission corridor to enable the interconnection and deliverability of new generation resources, the addition of new large customer block loads, a reduction of transmission congestion, and continued reliable and resilient service to ELL's existing customers.

Accordingly, the Company requests that the Commission find, pursuant to the 2024 Siting Order, that the construction of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project is in the public interest and can proceed expeditiously so that the Company can undertake the significant construction and investment necessary to ensure that southeast Louisiana, specifically the Amite South area, and the entire State of Louisiana can benefit from this important opportunity to create economic development, jobs for Louisiana citizens, and expansion of the tax base for the State and local government.

II. COMPANY WITNESSES

With this Application, the Company submits the Direct Testimonies of Company witnesses to include Michelle P. Bourg, Chad J. Ladner, Erik M. Guillot, and Ryan D. Jones. The purpose of the Direct Testimony of each witness is as follows:

- **Michelle P. Bourg** – Ms. Bourg is the Vice President, Business and Economic Development, for the Company. She describes the expected load growth in Louisiana, which is one of the drivers of the need for this Project. She also discusses the Commission's important role in overseeing and facilitating the expansion of the Company's infrastructure to accommodate and foster the anticipated growth. She further discusses other important drivers of the need for this Project, which include improved reliability, increased resilience, additional load-serving capability, and transmission system congestion relief. She also identifies the other ELL witnesses whose Direct Testimony supports this filing, and she provides a summary of their Direct Testimony.

- **Chad J. Ladner** – Mr. Ladner is the Senior Manager, Power Delivery Planning, within the Project and Portfolio Development group of Entergy Services, LLC's ("ESL")[3] Power Delivery Organization. He describes the transmission planning process and extensive analyses that were conducted to identify and select the Babel – Webre 500kV Project. He further describes MISO's MTEP process and the Babel – Webre 500kV Project's development, submission, review, and approval through the MTEP process. Mr. Ladner describes the significance of MISO's classification of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project as a Baseline Reliability Project and discusses the reliability, resilience, load-serving capability, congestion-relief, and production cost reduction benefits of the Project. He discusses the alternatives considered and presents the technical information and studies to support the Project.

- **Erik M. Guillot** – Mr. Guillot is the Senior Manager, Project Management – Capital Projects. He describes the components of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project and provides illustrations, diagrams, and single-line drawings of the location and siting of the Project. He provides the estimated costs for the Project and associated right-of-way acquisition, and he discusses the anticipated sources of funding for the Project. Mr. Guillot further provides the timeline and milestones to complete construction.

- **Ryan D. Jones** – Mr. Jones is the Director, Regulatory Affairs, for ELL. He describes the requirements of the 2024 Siting Order and how the Direct Testimony and exhibits included with the Company's Application provide the information required for the Commission to certify that the Babel – Webre 500kV Project serves the public convenience and necessity and is in the public interest in compliance with the 2024 Siting Order. In addition, Mr. Jones provides the estimated revenue requirement of the Project and discusses rate recovery and the potential bill impacts to ELL's customers.

Through this Application, along with the Direct Testimonies and accompanying exhibits, the Company provides the information necessary to establish and support a Commission determination that the public convenience and necessity will be served by the completion and siting of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project.

[3] ESL is the service company affiliate of the Entergy Operating Companies ("EOCs") that provides engineering, planning, accounting, technical, regulatory, and other administrative support services to each of the EOCs. The EOCs include ELL; Entergy Mississippi, LLC ("EML"); Entergy Arkansas, LLC ("EAL"); Entergy New Orleans, LLC ("ENO"); and Entergy Texas, Inc. ("ETI").

III. THE BABEL – WEBRE 500KV PROJECT

A. Components of the Project

As described by Company witness Mr. Guillot, the Babel – Webre 500kV Project includes the following components:

- **Construction of a new version of the Webre 500kV Switching Station**
    - Acquire property near the existing Webre 500kV Switching Station.
    - Build a new Webre 500kV Switching Station, consisting of a 4-breaker ring bus air insulated switching station.
    - Connect the existing Wells, Big Cajun and Bayou Labutte 500kV lines to the new Webre 500kV Switching Station.
    - Demolish the existing gas-insulated Webre 500kV Switching Station.
- **Coordinate on Construction of the Babel 500kV Switching Station**
    - Coordinated construction of ETI's new Babel 500kV Switching Station by adding a 500kV line bay to connect the new 500kV line.
    - Relay protection and control for the new 500kV line.
- **Babel-Webre 500kV Transmission Line**
    - Build a new 151-mile 500kV Line from Babel 500kV Switching Station in Newton County, Texas to Webre 500kV Switching Station in Iberville Parish, Louisiana.
- **Right of Way (ROW)**
    - Acquire a total of approximately 151 miles of new right of way for the transmission line of which approximately 147 miles will be in Louisiana and approximately 4 miles will be in Texas.

Construction of the Project is expected to begin in the third quarter of 2027, and the expected in-service date is August 2029.

B. Project Costs and Schedule

In his Direct Testimony, Mr. Guillot explains that the current cost estimate for the Babel – Webre 500kV Project is $1.238 billion[4] (Class 3 estimate). Mr. Guillot's Direct Testimony also summarizes the Project costs by component (in Exhibit EMG-6, which contains highly sensitive protected materials ("HSPM")) and by category and Operating Company (in Exhibit EMG-7 (HSPM)). Cost estimates will be updated and refined as the Project is executed.

Subject to change, the timelines for each component of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project are detailed below (as included in Table 1 of Mr. Guillot's Direct Testimony):

Event	Start Date	Completion
Board Approval for Project	N/A	October 2025
Webre 500kV Switching Station – Land Acquisition	June 2025	January 2027
Webre 500kV Switching Station – Permitting	April 2026	July 2027
Webre 500kV Switching Station – Construction	September 2027	December 2028
Webre 500kV Switching Station – Proposed In-Service Date		August 2029
Construction of Tie Lines to 500kV Switching Station – Permitting	April 2026	July 2027
Construction of Tie Lines to 500kV Switching Station – Construction	November 2027	May 2028
Construction of Tie Lines to 500kV Switching Station – Proposed In-Service Date		December 2028
Babel 500kV Switching Station Expansion – Construction	October 2027	February 2029
Babel 500kV Switching Station Expansion – Proposed In-Service Date		March 2029
Babel-Webre 500kV Line – ROW Acquisition	June 2025	January 2028
Babel-Webre 500kV Line – Permitting	April 2026	July 2027
Babel-Webre 500kV Line – Construction	July 2027	July 2029
Babel-Webre 500kV Line – Proposed In-Service Date		August 2029

[4] Approximately $33 million of the project costs will be borne by ETI for the construction of the additional bay at the Babel Switching Station and the approximately four miles of transmission line to the west of the Sabine River.

IV. PUBLIC INTEREST DETERMINATION

A. The Commission's Transmission Siting Order

The Commission's 2024 Siting Order defines a Transmission Facility as:

> [A] system of structures, wires, insulators and associated hardware, but not including switching or substations, that carry electric energy over distances and that are located in whole or in part within the State of Louisiana, regardless of whether the line provides electric service to customers within the state, and that would be constructed and operated at or above a nominal 100kV, exceeds one mile in length, and the estimated cost to construct exceeds $20 million. A Transmission Facility shall include the construction of any projects, or group/portfolio of projects, designed to resolve a common transmission-related concern.[5]

The 2024 Siting Order generally provides that any utility seeking to construct a transmission project meeting the definition of Transmission Facility must first obtain LPSC certification that the project serves the public convenience and necessity unless it qualifies for certain enumerated exemptions.[6] Company witness Ryan D. Jones addresses the development of the 2024 Siting Order and the Company's compliance with that Order.

B. The Babel – Webre 500kV Project Will Serve the Public Convenience and Necessity

The Company requests that the Commission find that the public convenience and necessity would be served by the construction of the Project and that the Project is therefore in the public interest. As Mr. Jones explains in his Direct Testimony, in issuing the 2024 Siting Order, the Commission acknowledged that it would certify a project it finds "to be in the public interest and

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[5] *See* 2024 Siting Order at Section II.A.

[6] *Id.* at Section I (Applicability) and Section VIII (Exemptions). As noted above, for the sake of completeness and context, the Babel – Webre 500kV Project also includes components for which the Company is not seeking certification under the 2024 Siting Order. The Company includes in its Application and Direct Testimony descriptions of the reconstruction of the Webre 500kV Switching Station as part of the Project, even though the 2024 Siting Order expressly excludes switching stations from the definition of "Transmission Facility" to which the Commission's certification requirement applies. *See* 2024 Siting Order at Section II(a) (definition of "Transmission Facility"). The Company also includes description of the coordination with ETI of the construction of an approximately 4-mile 500kV transmission line in Texas and the construction of the Babel Switching Station in Texas.

the interests of affected ratepayers."[7] In making a determination that a project is in the public interest and the interests of affected ratepayers, "the Commission may consider the expected impact of such Transmission Facility on costs, retail rates, service reliability, reduction of congestion, material economic benefits, the interstate or intrastate benefits expected to be achieved, and whether the proposed Transmission Facility is consistent with public policy, including policy goals of the Commission."[8] In addition, the Commission may consider "whether construction of this Transmission Facility (as opposed to construction of another transmission facility or construction of generation, or non-transmission alternative, for example) is a reasonable and cost-effective solution to the problem being addressed by the Transmission Facility proposed in the Application."[9]

The Babel – Webre 500kV Project meets or surpasses these standards. As explained by Ms. Bourg and Mr. Ladner, the Project will address projected widespread transmission reliability constraints associated with expected load growth in southeast Louisiana – and is also required to remain in compliance with NERC regulations governing transmission reliability planning as ELL extends service to a significant data center load in northeast Louisiana. As described by Ms. Bourg in her Direct Testimony, ELL has over 2,600 MW of load under study in the industrial corridor on the West Bank of the Mississippi River between Baton Rouge and New Orleans, as of December 2025. In his Direct Testimony, Mr. Ladner explains that MISO classified the Project as a BRP to ensure continued reliable service to ELL customers in the wake of significant load growth. The Babel – Webre 500kV Project—with the Commission's approval—will play a critical role in

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7 *Id.* at Section IV.

8 *Id.*

9 *Id.*

ELL's ability to support these customer projects, and this anticipated growth will create jobs, tax revenue, and long-term economic opportunity for Louisiana residents.

As Ms. Bourg and Mr. Ladner further explain, in addition to supporting expected load growth and the economic development benefits that the growth will provide for the State of Louisiana, the Project will provide other benefits that are equally important to ELL customers and the Commission to include: improving operational reliability by (1) meeting the EOCs' local planning criteria for load-serving capability; (2) providing operational flexibility, including addressing a constraint that was involved in the May 25, 2025 load-shed event, and flexibility with respect to future ELL generation resource planning in south Louisiana; (3) improving extreme event resilience, including by providing a new east-west 500kV pathway built to the Company's latest wind-load rating standards and farther inland from landfalling hurricanes than current similar facilities; and (4) enabling more efficient generation dispatch in the MISO electric market to create production cost savings for Louisiana customers.

Based on these factors, the Project is firmly in the public interest and should be certified as such by the Commission.

C. Information Required in Certification Filing

As summarized by Mr. Jones, and through the Direct Testimonies of ELL's other witnesses, the Company has provided the information required by the 2024 Siting Order as follows:

- Requirement V(a): ELL is the Applicant in this proceeding and the only entity participating in the construction of the Louisiana portion of the Project.
- Requirement V(b): Mr. Guillot provides a description of each component of the Project.

- Requirement V(c): Mr. Ladner and Ms. Bourg provide detailed explanations of the justification for the Project. In addition, Mr. Ladner describes the analyses performed by ELL and MISO to determine that the Project is needed to improve reliability and ensure compliance with NERC standards, accommodate projected load growth (including major economic development projects), and increase load-serving capability in a transmission-constrained region of the area served by ELL.
- Requirement V(d-e): Mr. Ladner explains that the proposed Transmission Facilities do not involve any designated National Interest Electric Transmission Corridor and, as such, federal backstop siting authority is not a factor with respect to the Project.
- Requirement V(f): Mr. Guillot provides the general proposed location of each component of the Project.
- Requirement V(g): Mr. Guillot discusses the anticipated source of funding for the Project.
- Requirement V(h): Mr. Guillot provides the Company's current best estimate of the cost of each component of the Project, which he explains is a Class 3 estimate and will be updated and refined as the Project is executed.
- Requirement V(i): Mr. Jones provides a discussion of the effect that the Project will have on customer rates.
- Requirement V(j): As exhibits to his Direct Testimony, Mr. Guillot provides a map detailing the routing and location of the Project (HSPM Exhibit EMG-1), a scoping diagram of the Project facilities (Exhibit EMG-2), drawings of the typical structures anticipated to be used in constructing the Project (Exhibit EMG-3), and

diagrams of the Babel and Webre 500kV Switching Stations (HSPM Exhibit EMG-4).

- Requirement V(k): Mr. Guillot discusses the current schedule and timeline for completing construction of each component of the Project and placing them in service.
- Requirement V(l): Mr. Guillot explains the Company's current plans for ROW acquisition.
- Requirement V(m): Ms. Bourg provides other information that the Company considers relevant to support a public interest determination (*e.g.*, the need to expand the Company's infrastructure and transmission capacity to accommodate the significant industrial expansion underway in southeast Louisiana, specifically in the Amite South area, as well as to remain in compliance with applicable regulations as the Company extends service to a major new customer data center project in northeast Louisiana).

V. REVENUE REQUIREMENT AND ESTIMATED BILL EFFECTS

The 2024 Siting Order requires that a certification application include "[a]n analysis, with supporting data, of the estimated effects on costs to ratepayers attributable to the proposed Transmission Facility, including an estimate of the impact of the cost of the Transmission Facility on rates of all the entity's customers within Louisiana."[10] To comply with this requirement, Mr. Jones provides the estimated revenue requirement of the Project, based on the current estimated cost of the Project, as well as the estimated effect on a residential customer bill for a customer

[10] *See* 2024 Siting Order at Section V(i).

using 1,000 kilowatt hours ("kWh") per month in the area served by ELL, assuming for purposes of this presentation only that the Project revenue requirement will be recovered on a dollar-for-dollar basis. Mr. Jones's calculations produce a total retail revenue requirement of $129.2 million for the Project, prior to consideration of any offsets for other revenue received from transmission wholesale customers.[11] Assuming the revenue requirement for the Project is reflected in rates on a dollar-for-dollar basis over Test Year 2024 billing determinants, a residential customer using 1,000 kWh per month would experience a bill increase of approximately $3.74.

As Mr. Jones explains, the Company is not requesting any specific rate treatment of the costs of the Project at this time, as that will ultimately be addressed in the context of a rate proceeding such as an annual Formula Rate Plan ("FRP") Evaluation Report Filing, a filing to extend the FRP or some other base rate proceeding. Accordingly, the Company is not asking for Commission approval of specific recovery of the Project revenue requirement outside of the normal course of ratemaking. In this proceeding, the Company is only requesting that, by virtue of a Commission finding that construction of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project is in the public interest, the costs of the Project be deemed eligible for recovery through the FRP to the extent the Company remains subject to one, or that the Commission authorize the creation of a regulatory asset which will accrue carrying charges on the next of tax balance at the then-effective weighted average cost of capital until such time that the costs can be reflected in rates in order to mitigate the effects of regulatory lag in the alternative where there is no FRP. In other words, if the

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[11] As Mr. Jones explains, it is important to note that the estimated revenue requirement is based on a Class 3 estimate, which reflects a range of accuracy of -20% to +30%. The Class 3 estimate aligns with the project development at this stage of a large transmission project. As Mr. Guillot explains, the Class 3 estimate will be refined as the Project development progresses and is executed. Therefore, while the estimated revenue requirement provided here is based on the best information currently available to the Company, it is expected to change; and it will be the final prudently incurred costs of the project that the Company seeks to recover in customer rates. The Commission should not view the Company's preliminary estimate as a cap or yardstick to assess the prudence of the Company's final project costs, as costs can deviate from estimates made at this stage for many reasons unrelated to the Company's prudence in executing the Project.

Company's FRP is still effective at the time that the Project is placed in service, and the Company has not received approval of some specific alternative recovery for the Project, the Company would recover the revenue requirement of the Project through the normal FRP recovery mechanisms. If instead the Company is not subject to an FRP and the costs have been recorded to an approved regulatory asset, it would seek separate Commission approval for any recovery of the proposed regulatory asset through a future rate proceeding. Since no specific recovery is being requested at this time, the estimated bill effects provide by Mr. Jones may not reflect precisely the actual customer impact that will be seen, through an FRP or otherwise, associated with the Project, although they are reasonable estimates of those effects.

VI. REQUEST FOR TIMELY TREATMENT

As Ms. Bourg and Mr. Jones explain, the Company is not seeking expedited consideration of this Application by the Commission. The Company is, however, respectfully requesting a decision that will enable the Company to commence construction of the components of the Project by July 2027 and to achieve an in-service date by August 2029 (under the Project timeline presented in Section VII of Mr. Guillot's Direct Testimony).

To the extent the Company's Application is uncontested by LPSC Staff or Intervenors, the Company respectfully requests that the Commission exercise its authority under the 2024 Siting Order such that the Commission may consider and issue a ruling on the Company's certification request within 90 days of the filing of the Application. If the Company's Application is contested, then the Company respectfully requests that the Commission consider and issue a ruling on the Company's certification request within 180 days of the filing of the Application as contemplated by the 2024 Siting Order. The requested approval time frames provide for adequate review by all parties under the 2024 Siting Order, and approval of the certification request by the Commission

within the review period established by the 2024 Siting Order (*i.e.*, within 90 days of filing if the Application is uncontested, or within 180 days of filing if the Application is contested) would be sufficient to enable the Company to (1) timely accommodate electric service to the new block loads developing in Amite South and (2) provide the needed benefits associated with the Babel – Webre 500kV Project to existing and new customers of ELL.

VII. SERVICE OF NOTICES AND PLEADINGS

The Company request that notices, correspondence, and other communications concerning this Application be directed to the following persons:

Lawrence J. Hand, Jr.
Ryan D. Jones
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solson@dwmrlaw.com

The Company requests that the foregoing persons be placed on the Official Service List for this proceeding and respectfully requests that the Commission permit the designation of more than one person to be placed on the Official Service List for service in this proceeding.

VIII. REQUEST FOR CONFIDENTIAL TREATMENT

Portions of the Direct Testimonies and exhibits supporting this Application contain information considered by the Company to be proprietary and confidential. Disclosure of certain portions of this information may expose the Company and its customers to an unreasonable risk of harm, including creating an artificial target for suppliers/vendors or creating physical security risks. Therefore, in light of the nature of such information, which includes commercially or competitively sensitive market information and sensitive infrastructure information, the Company has submitted two versions of the Direct Testimonies of Ms. Bourg, Mr. Ladner, and Mr. Guillot, one marked "Public Redacted Version" and the other marked "Highly Sensitive Protected Materials Version." In anticipation of the execution of a suitable confidentiality agreement in this Docket, the Confidential Versions bear the designation "Highly Sensitive Protected Materials" or words of similar import. Although the confidential information and documents included with this Application may be reviewed by appropriate representatives of the LPSC Staff and interested parties pursuant to the terms and conditions of a suitable confidentiality agreement once such an agreement has been executed in this Docket, this confidential information also is being provided pursuant to, and shall be exempt from public disclosure pursuant to, the Commission's General Order dated August 31, 1992 and Rule 12.1 of the Rules of Practice and Procedure of the LPSC.

IX. PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, for the foregoing reasons, Entergy Louisiana, LLC respectfully requests that, after due and lawful proceedings are held, the Commission, subject to the fullest extent of its jurisdiction, grant relief and give its approval of the Application. In particular, the Company requests that the Commission:

1. Find that, under the 2024 Siting Order, the construction, completion, and siting of the components of the Louisiana portion of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project[12] will serve the public convenience and necessity and be in the public interest and are therefore approved, including principally the following Project components:

   a. the construction of a new approximately 147-mile 500kV transmission line in south Louisiana extending to the Texas border (Sabine River); and

   b. the reconstruction of the Webre 500kV Switching Station;

   and further find that undertaking the construction of the Project components would therefore be prudent and in accordance with the 2024 Siting Order and other applicable Commission orders;

2. Find that under the circumstances described in the Company's Application, the Commission's public interest determination prior to ELL's construction of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project would be beneficial to the Commission and ultimately to customers;

3. Find that the generalized siting of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project is appropriate and that its construction is a reasonable and cost-effective solution to provide reliable electric service to the anticipated load growth in southeast Louisiana and the Amite South region, and to maintain compliance with applicable federal regulations as the Company serves a new large load customer in northeast Louisiana, as described in the Company's Application;

4. Find that the actual retail revenue requirement associated with the prudently incurred costs of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project, an estimate of which is provided by Mr. Jones in his Direct Testimony, is deemed eligible for recovery by the Company at the time that the components of the Babel – Webre 500kV Project are placed in service through the FRP to the extent the Company remains subject to one, or that the Commission authorize the creation of a regulatory asset which shall accrue carrying charges on the net of tax balance at the then-effective weighted average cost of capital until such time that the costs can be reflected in rates in order to mitigate the effects of regulatory lag in the alternative where there is no FRP;

5. Find that, as provided in the Commission's Special Order No. 7-2000, dated March 22, 2000, the confidential Direct Testimony, exhibits, and other materials referenced in this Application shall be exempt from public disclosure pursuant to the Commission's General Order dated August 31, 1992, and Rule 12.1 of the Rules of Practice and Procedure of the Louisiana Public Service Commission;

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[12] As noted above, the certification requested in this Application is for the portion of the transmission line and related components located in Louisiana, which will be owned by ELL. ETI, which will own the portion of the Project located in Texas, will pursue any necessary certification and approval of the portion of the line and the Babel Switching Station in Texas from the PUCT, and ETI will be responsible for paying for the portions of the Project in Texas.

6. Direct that the period for interventions and protests be shortened to 15 days;

7. Direct the procedural steps necessary to facilitate a Commission decision on the Company's Application within 180 days of the filing of the Application (consistent with Section X of the Commission's 2024 Siting Order);

8. Direct that notice of all matters in these proceedings be sent to Lawrence J. Hand, Jr., Ryan D. Jones, Matthew T. Brown, Meta C. Danzey, Mark Strain, and Scott Olson as representatives of the Company; and

9. Grant such other relief to which the Company is entitled.

Respectfully submitted,

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